

Unit 6: Digitalization in Nepalese Perspective

Lecture 1: Introduction to E-Governance

Learning Objectives

- Define digitalization
- Explain e-governance
- Understand Nepal context
- Identify benefits and challenges

What is Digitalization?

- Digitalization means using digital technology to improve public services and processes.
- Example:
 - Before → Paper form submission
 - After → Online service submission

Why Digitalization Matters

- **Faster service delivery**

Using eNagarik, citizens can apply for certificates and get service updates quickly without visiting government offices.

- **Transparency**

Online tax systems of Inland Revenue Department allow citizens to track tax filing and payment records.

- **Reduced corruption**

Digital workflow reduces middlemen and unofficial payments because requests are processed electronically.

- **Better access**

People from rural areas can submit applications online if they have internet access.

- **Citizen convenience**

Services are available 24/7.

No need to stand in long queues or travel long distances for basic services.

What is E-Governance?

E-Governance is the use of ICT by government to deliver services efficiently and transparently.

Goals of E-Governance with Examples

- **Transparency**
 - Government decisions and service processes are visible to citizens.
 - Example: Online public service tracking helps people know the status of their applications.
- **Efficiency**
 - Digital systems reduce paperwork and manual processing time.
 - Example: Electronic tax processing and automated record storage speed up administrative work.
- **Accountability**
 - Officials and departments can be monitored through digital records and audit trails.
 - Example: Digital transaction logs help identify delays or service errors.
- **Citizen participation**
 - Citizens can submit complaints, feedback, or service requests through digital platforms.
 - Example: Online feedback systems and digital grievance reporting portals.

Types of E-Governance

- G2C – Government to Citizen

Example: Online certificate application

- G2B – Government to Business

Example: Business registration

- G2G – Government to Government

Data sharing

- G2E – Government to Employee

Payroll system

E-Governance in Nepal

- eNagarik Portal
 - Online tax filing system
 - Digital land records
 - Municipal digital services
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- Example:
 - Citizen applies for police clearance certificate online.

Benefits of E-Governance

- Faster processing
- Less paperwork
- Increased transparency
- Better public trust
- 24/7 access to services

Challenges in Nepal

- Internet access gap
- Digital literacy
- Infrastructure issues
- Cybersecurity risks
- Resistance to change

Class Discussion

- What is one benefit of e-governance?
- Is Nepal fully digital yet?
- How can rural citizens benefit?